Brand & Design Spec — Fareburn

Product: Fareburn — AI Rewards Scanner for Credit Card Points
Tagline: Your points are worth more than you think
Stage: 3 — Design
Date: 2026-03-07
Designer: @designer

Design Philosophy

Fareburn is "Bloomberg Terminal for Points Nerds — if Bloomberg was designed by someone who actually cared about design."

The unforgettable element: a **live opportunity counter** on the hero — a large amber number showing "247 award opportunities found this week" with sparklines. Immediately communicates the product's core value: it proactively FINDS things for you while you sleep.

Every design decision flows from one idea: **This tool is smarter than the user's manual search routine.** It should feel authoritative, precise, and warm — not cold like a spreadsheet, not juvenile like a travel blog.

A. Brand Tokens

Colors (CSS Variables)

```
:root {

  /* Backgrounds */

  --background: #0D0C0A;

  --surface: #1A1814;

  --surface-hover: #241F18;

  --surface-elevated: #2A2520;

  /* Borders */

  --border: #2E2820;
```

```
  --border-subtle: #221E18;

  /* Text */

  --text-primary: #F5F0E8;

  --text-secondary: #A89880;

  --text-muted: #6B5E4E;

  /* Accent — Amber Gold */

  --accent: #E8A020;

  --accent-hover: #F0B030;

  --accent-foreground: #0D0C0A;

  --accent-subtle: rgba(232, 160, 32, 0.1);

  --accent-glow: rgba(232, 160, 32, 0.15);

  /* Status Colors */

  --destructive: #C84B4B;

  --destructive-foreground: #F5F0E8;

  --success: #4BA86E;

  --success-foreground: #0D0C0A;

  --warning: #E8A020;

  /* Special */

  --ring: #E8A020;

  --muted: #1A1814;

  --muted-foreground: #A89880;

}
```

Color Rationale:

- `#0D0C0A` — Almost-black with warm brown undertone. Not cold. Premium, like aged leather.
- `#E8A020` — Amber gold. Not yellow (cheap), not orange (loud). This is liquid gold. Every competitor uses blue — we own amber.
- `#F5F0E8` — Cream white with slight warmth. Harsh white (`#FFFFFF`) feels sterile for financial data.

Typography

```
:root {

  --font-display: "DM Serif Display", Georgia, serif;

  --font-body: "Plus Jakarta Sans", system-ui, sans-serif;

  --font-mono: "JetBrains Mono", "Courier New", monospace;

}
```

Font Usage:

- `DM Serif Display` → H1, H2, hero headlines, section headings. Has authority and elegance — the "Bloomberg anchor" quality. Never use for body text.
- `Plus Jakarta Sans` → All body text, UI labels, nav items, button text, form fields. Clean, modern, readable at any size.
- `JetBrains Mono` → Stats, numbers, point balances, route codes (JFK→NRT), value scores, any data/code text. Precision signals trust.

Type Scale: | Token | Size | Usage | |-------|------|-------| | xs | 12px | Fine print, labels, tags | | sm | 14px | Secondary text, metadata | | base | 16px | Body text | | lg | 20px | Card titles, emphasis | | xl | 24px | Section subtitles | | 2xl | 32px | Section headings (H2) | | 3xl | 48px | Page headings (H1) | | 4xl | 64px | Hero display text | | 5xl | 80px | Opportunity counter stat |

Spacing

Base unit: 4px

Section padding: 96px vertical (desktop), 48px (mobile)

Container max-width: 1280px

Content max-width: 800px (text-heavy sections)

Sidebar width: 240px

Card padding: 24px

Border Radius

Tiny: 4px — input fields, tags

Small: 8px — small cards, buttons

Medium: 12px — regular cards

Large: 16px — hero cards, modal containers

XL: 20px — featured/highlighted cards

Full: 9999px — badges, pills, round avatars

Shadows & Elevation

--shadow-sm: 0 1px 3px rgba(0, 0, 0, 0.4);

--shadow-card: 0 4px 16px rgba(0, 0, 0, 0.5), 0 1px 4px rgba(0, 0, 0, 0.3);

--shadow-elevated: 0 8px 32px rgba(0, 0, 0, 0.6), 0 2px 8px rgba(0, 0, 0, 0.4);

--shadow-modal: 0 24px 64px rgba(0, 0, 0, 0.8);

--shadow-amber-glow: 0 0 24px rgba(232, 160, 32, 0.2);

--shadow-amber-intense: 0 0 48px rgba(232, 160, 32, 0.35);

B. Site Map

Pages:

├── / (landing page — public)

│ └── sections: navbar, hero, problem, solution, features, how-it-works, pricing-preview, testimonials, FAQ, final-CTA, footer

├── /about

│ └── sections: navbar, hero, mission-stat, our-values, how-we-think, team, timeline, CTA, footer

├── /pricing

```
│   └── sections: navbar, header, tier-cards, feature-comparison, FAQ, trust-badges, footer
├── /signup
├── /login
├── /tools/calculator (public, no auth — lead magnet)
├── /dashboard (authenticated)
│   ├── /dashboard (overview — opportunities feed + stats)
│   ├── /dashboard/alerts (manage route alerts)
│   └── /dashboard/calculator (full calculator tool)
├── /blog (content marketing — list view + article pages)
├── /contact
├── /privacy
├── /terms
├── /deck (pitch presentation)
└── /docs (document hub — sidebar nav, 5 sections)
    ├── Research
    ├── GTM
    ├── Marketing
    ├── Brand
    └── Pitch
```

C. UI Mockups

All mockups generated at 2K (4K for dashboard). Located in `public/mockups/`:

File	Description	Resolution
`landing-mockup.png`	Full landing page — all 10 sections	2K
`dashboard-mockup.png`	Core app dashboard — opportunities + sidebar + stats	4K
`about-mockup.png`	About page — mission, values, team	2K
`pricing-mockup.png`	Pricing page — 3 tiers + comparison table	2K
`auth-mockup.png`	Signup/login split-screen	2K
`calculator-mockup.png`	Public Points-to-Seat Calculator tool	2K
`alerts-mockup.png`	Dashboard alerts management page	2K

D. Page-by-Page Design Specs

Navbar (All Pages)

Component: `NavigationMenu` from shadcn/ui + custom sticky wrapper

Desktop:

[Logo: flame-icon + "Fareburn" wordmark] .... [Features] [Pricing] [About] [Blog] ... [Sign In] [Start Free →]

- Background: `--background` with `backdrop-blur-md` when scrolled (glassmorphism on scroll)
- Border-bottom: `1px solid var(--border)` appears on scroll
- Logo: SVG flame icon in `--accent` + "Fareburn" in `--font-display`
- Nav links: `--text-secondary`, hover to `--text-primary`, underline animation
- "Sign In": Ghost button style
- "Start Free": Amber filled button `bg-accent text-accent-foreground`
- Sticky: `position: sticky; top: 0; z-index: 50`

Mobile: Hamburger menu → full-screen slide-down drawer with all links

Animation: `opacity: 0 → 1` + `translateY(-4px → 0)` on page load (0.3s)

Footer (All Pages)

Layout:

Row 1: [Fareburn wordmark + tagline] [Products] [Company] [Legal] [Social]

Row 2: © 2026 Fareburn Inc. All rights reserved. Privacy Policy | Terms of Service

- Background: `--background` with `border-top: 1px solid var(--border)`
- Tagline: "Find the award. Book the seat. Burn the miles." in `--text-muted`
- Link columns: Features, Pricing, Calculator, Blog / About, Contact / Privacy, Terms
- Social: Twitter/X, Reddit links

Landing Page (/)

Hero Section — THE SIGNATURE ELEMENT

Layout: 60/40 split — left content, right interactive card

- Left side:
    - Small badge: 🔥 `Award alerts powered by AI` in amber pill
    - H1 (DM Serif Display, 64px): "Your Points Are Worth\nMore Than You Think"
    - Subtext (Plus Jakarta Sans, 18px, `--text-secondary`): "Fareburn scans 50+ airlines and hotel programs to find when YOUR points unlock premium seats — and alerts you instantly."
    - CTA row: [**Scan My Points Free** (amber)] [See How It Works →]
    - Trust line: "No credit card required · 12,000+ travelers use Fareburn"
- Right side: Glassmorphism "opportunity counter" card
    - Card: `bg-surface border border-border rounded-xl p-6 shadow-amber-glow`
    - Large JetBrains Mono stat: "247" in `--accent` at 80px
    - Label: "award opportunities found this week" in `--text-muted`
    - 3 mini-cards: live award feed (NYC→NRT, JFK→LHR, etc.) with pulsing amber dots
    - Sparkline chart in amber

Animation: Hero reveals staggered on load — badge (0ms), H1 (100ms), subtext (200ms), CTAs (300ms), card (400ms with slight scale). All Framer Motion `fadeInUp`.

Problem Section

- Three problem cards in row, dark surface `--surface`
- Each: icon (warm red-amber), bold problem statement, one-line context
- P1: "You have the points. You don't know when award seats open."
- P2: "Transfer math between programs is time-consuming and confusing."
- P3: "By the time you search, the award space is gone."

Solution Section

- Full-width dark section with amber left-border accent
- H2: "Fareburn bridges the gap — your balance, live availability, transfer math, done."
- Flow diagram: [Your Accounts] → [Fareburn AI] → [Award Availability] → [You Get Alerted]
- Hero image: `public/images/hero-illustration.png`

Features Grid — Bento Layout

- 6 cards in bento grid (2 large, 4 small)
- Large card 1: "Real-Time Award Alerts" with animated notification mockup
- Large card 2: "Transfer Path Optimizer" with calc animation
- 4 smaller: Calculator, Multi-Program, Value Scoring, Route History
- Feature icons from `public/images/feature-icons.png`

How It Works

- 3 steps with amber numbered circles + connecting lines
- Step 1: "Connect Your Programs" — enter balances (30 sec)
- Step 2: "Set Your Routes" — tell us where you want to go
- Step 3: "We Alert You" — instant email when awards open

Pricing Preview

- 3 tier cards (simplified — full pricing on /pricing)
- Link to full pricing page

Testimonials

- Horizontal scroll carousel on mobile, 3-col grid desktop
- Quote cards from r/churning-style power users

FAQ Accordion

- shadcn/ui Accordion, 8 questions
- Dark surface, amber `+`/`-` icon

Final CTA

- Dark amber-tinted section (`rgba(232,160,32,0.05)` bg)
- H2: "Stop missing award seats. Start getting alerts."
- One amber button

Dashboard (/dashboard)

Layout:

[Sidebar 240px] | [Main Content]

Sidebar:

- `--background` bg with `border-right: 1px solid var(--border)`
- Logo at top
- Nav items with amber indicator for active: Overview, Alerts, My Programs, Calculator, Settings
- Bottom: User avatar + plan badge + upgrade prompt (free users)

Overview — Stats Row:

- 4 stat cards with JetBrains Mono numbers
- "Total Points Value: $4,847" / "Active Alerts: 12" / "Opportunities This Week: 38" / "Best Deal Available"
- Each card: sparkline (amber line), trend arrow, amber accent

Opportunities Feed:

- Real-time list of award opportunities matching user's connected programs
- Each award card: route, cabin class, required points, partner airline, value score (★ 8.2), "Alert Me" or "Available Now!" CTA
- HIGH VALUE: left amber border `border-l-4 border-amber-500`
- AVAILABLE NOW!: green `--success` border with glow

My Programs Panel (sidebar right):

- Connected loyalty accounts with balances
- Amber "+" to add new program
- Transfer Calculator mini-widget below

Responsive: Sidebar becomes bottom tab bar on mobile (5 icons)

Pricing Page (/pricing)

Three Tiers:

Feature	**Free**	**Starter $15/mo**	**Corporate $149/mo**
Loyalty programs	1	Unlimited	Unlimited
Route alerts	1	Unlimited	Unlimited
Alert channels	-	Email + SMS	Email + SMS + Slack
Transfer optimizer	-	✓	✓
Value scoring	Basic	Full	Full
Team seats	-	-	Up to 25
Priority support	-	-	✓
API access	-	-	✓

Visual Treatment:

- Free: `--surface` card, subtle border
- Starter: amber `border-2 border-accent` with soft amber glow background, "Most Popular" badge
- Corporate: `--surface-elevated` with darker treatment

Monthly/Yearly Toggle: Amber accent, yearly shows "Save 20%" badge

---

Auth Pages (/signup, /login)

Layout: 50/50 split

Left (Form Side):

- Clean, no distractions
- Fareburn logo at top

- H1: "Start scanning in 60 seconds"
- Form with amber focus rings: email, password, (name for signup)
- Amber submit button
- Google OAuth (dark outlined)
- Trust: "🔒 Encrypted. Never sold."

Right (Product Side):

- Dark amber radial gradient background using `hero-glow.png`
- Key stats: "12,000+ travelers", "247 opportunities/week avg", "$2,400 avg untapped value found"
- One testimonial quote
- Subtle product screenshot or illustration

/tools/calculator (Public Tool)

Purpose: Lead magnet — no auth required, full SEO value

Above Tool:

- H1 (DM Serif Display): "Find Out What Your Points Can Buy"
- Subtext: "Free forever. No signup required."

The Calculator:

- Large dark glassmorphism card
- Left: Select programs + enter balances + pick route + cabin class
- Right: Results cards (auto-updates as user types)
- Each result: airline, award program, points needed, transfer path, value score, "Create Alert →" CTA
- "Create Alert" CTA drives signup conversion

Social Proof Below: "47,000+ searches · $2.3M in award value found"

/docs Hub (/docs)

Layout:

- Fixed sidebar left (240px): Research, GTM, Marketing, Brand, Pitch
- Content area right: selected doc summary + link to full Google Doc
- Mobile: Sidebar becomes dropdown select or hamburger drawer

Styling:

- Same brand tokens throughout
- Reading-first typography (base 16px body text)
- Sections collapsible in sidebar
- "Open in Google Drive →" button per section

E. Component Specs

Component	shadcn Base	Custom Styling
Button (primary)	`Button`	`bg-accent text-accent-foreground hover:bg-accent-hover`
Button (ghost)	`Button variant="ghost"`	`text-text-primary hover:bg-surface-hover`
Button (outline)	`Button variant="outline"`	`border-border text-text-primary hover:bg-surface`
Card	`Card`	`bg-surface border-border rounded-xl shadow-card`
Card (featured)	`Card`	`bg-surface border-2 border-accent rounded-xl shadow-amber-glow`
Input	`Input`	`bg-surface border-border text-text-primary focus:ring-2 focus:ring-accent focus:border-accent`
Badge	`Badge`	Amber: `bg-accent/10 text-accent border border-accent/30`
Alert (success)	`Alert`	`bg-success/10 border-success text-success`
Dialog	`Dialog`	`bg-surface border-border shadow-modal`

Component	shadcn Base	Custom Styling
Accordion	`Accordion`	`border-border, trigger text-text-primary, amber chevron`
Navigation	`NavigationMenu`	Custom sticky + blur scroll behavior
Tabs	`Tabs`	`bg-surface, active amber underline`
Select	`Select`	`bg-surface border-border focus:ring-accent`

F. Website Images

All in `public/images/`:

File	Usage	Size
`logo-placeholder.png`	Navbar/footer logo until artist delivers	1K
`hero-illustration.png`	Landing hero section right panel background	2K
`feature-icons.png`	Features grid section — 6 amber icon set	1K
`bg-pattern.png`	Dark background texture/overlay for page atmosphere	1K
`hero-glow.png`	Atmospheric amber glow for auth page right side	2K
`about-visual.png`	About page mission section illustration	2K

Note to coder: All images are dark-optimized. `bg-pattern.png` should be used as `background-image: url(...)` with `opacity: 0.4` overlay on dark sections for depth. `hero-glow.png` as absolute positioned overlay on hero section.

G. Artist Brief

ARTIST BRIEF — Fareburn

Brand tokens: See Google Drive Brand folder (link in Trello)

LOGO:

- Concept: A stylized amber flame that also reads as "F" — or an upward

  momentum spark/arrow suggesting discovery and opportunity.

  Warm, energetic, but restrained. This is financial data, not a campfire app.

- Style: Icon + wordmark horizontal. Icon on left.

- Wordmark: "Fareburn" in DM Serif Display or a slightly customized serif.

  Not bold-heavy. Elegant precision over aggressive boldness.

- Color: Icon in amber #E8A020, wordmark in #F5F0E8 on dark bg.

  Must also work: icon-only in amber (app icon), all-white version, all-dark version.

- Sizes must work: 16px favicon, 32px favicon, 120px navbar, 200px full logo

- Constraint: The flame/spark must be distinct from generic "fire" logos.

  Think: oxidation spark, ignition moment, not camping aesthetic.

SOCIAL MEDIA KIT:

- LinkedIn banner (1584×396):

  Dark #0D0C0A bg, "Fareburn" in large amber wordmark centered,

  tagline below: "Find the award. Book the seat. Burn the miles."

  Subtle network/flight path illustration in background (low opacity).

- Twitter/X header (1500×500):

  Similar treatment — dark bg, amber wordmark, route network texture.

  Can be more dynamic/angular than LinkedIn.

- OG image (1200×630):

  Product screenshot composite — dark dashboard UI on left,

  "247 award opportunities found this week" amber stat on right.

  URL: fareburn.com at bottom. Brand typefaces.

- App icon (if needed — future): 1024×1024. The flame/F mark on dark bg.

H. /docs Hub Design

Layout: Sidebar left + content right (identical to what's described in Page Specs)

5 sections with doc links:

1. **Research** — IdeaBrowser analysis, market sizing, competitor breakdown
2. **GTM** — Go-to-market strategy, community playbook, distribution channels
3. **Marketing** — Content calendar, ad briefs, email sequences
4. **Brand** — This document + logo files + color tokens + typography
5. **Pitch** — Pitch deck + one-pager + investor memo

Each section shows: title, 1-line summary, "Open in Google Drive →" button.

I. The Unforgettable Element

The Opportunity Counter — a large amber JetBrains Mono number, animated counting up, showing "247 award opportunities found this week." This single element, in the hero, immediately makes the product's value proposition visceral. Users don't need to be told what the product does — they SEE it working in real time.

Supporting visual: 3 live award feed cards beneath the counter with pulsing amber status dots. Each card shows a real-sounding route (NYC→NRT, JFK→CDG, LAX→SYD), cabin class, and required points. This is not a mockup — it should animate with subtle cycling in the live product.

Secondary signature: The amber color itself. In a sea of blue fintech tools, the amber-gold immediately differentiates. Users who visit competitor sites and come to Fareburn will notice.

Cohesion Notes for Coder

1. **CSS variables only** — never hardcode hex values. If the theme needs to change, it changes once.
2. **JetBrains Mono for all numbers** — point balances, stats, route codes, value scores — everything numerical uses mono.
3. **DM Serif Display for headers only** — don't use it for body text or UI labels.
4. **Amber sparingly** — `--accent` is the signal color. Too much amber = no signal. Reserve for: primary CTAs, active states, high-value badges, the opportunity counter, status indicators.
5. **Dark grain texture** — apply `bg-pattern.png` as subtle overlay on key sections. Creates depth and prevents the flat-black aesthetic.
6. **Card hover:** `translateY(-2px)` + `shadow-amber-glow` appears on card hover. Subtle lift.
7. **Loading states** — all data tables/feeds should have skeleton screens (dark animated pulse) while loading.

Mockups: `~/Dev/fareburn/public/mockups/`
Images: `~/Dev/fareburn/public/images/`
Google Drive Brand folder: ChimeStream Portfolio/fareburn/Brand/